

Δημοσθένης ὁ Ἀθηναῖος

Demosthenes of Athens Against Philip and the Courts

eul_aid: fsm

Period: [Κλασική](#) Classical

Dialect: [Ἀττική](#) Attic

Domain: [Ῥητορική](#) Oratory

Format: [Λόγος](#) Oration

Demosthenes was an Athenian orator and statesman of the 4th century BCE. His political career was defined by his opposition to the expansion of Macedon under King Philip II. Born to a wealthy family, he was orphaned young and his inheritance was mismanaged by his guardians. According to ancient accounts, he overcame a speech impediment through determined self-training.

He began his career as a speechwriter for private lawsuits before emerging as a major public figure. His most famous works are political speeches urging Athens to resist Philip, including the Philippics and Olynthiacs. He also delivered celebrated judicial speeches, such as *On the Crown*, a successful defense of his entire political career. In total, 61 speeches survive under his name, though modern scholars question the authenticity of some.

Following Athens' final defeat by Macedon and a failed revolt, Demosthenes was condemned to death and took his own life in 322 BCE. He is considered the greatest of the Athenian orators. His works were studied for centuries as masterpieces of rhetorical technique, argument, and powerful emotion. Historically, he represents the voice of Athenian democracy and resistance to external domination. His speeches provide a critical window into the political and legal world of classical Greece. His legacy was so influential that the Roman orator Cicero later modeled himself on Demosthenes.

Works (64)

- [κατὰ Ἀνδροτίωνος παρανόμων](#) · [Against Androton for Illegal Acts](#) · 74 passages
- [κατὰ Ἀφόβου ἐπιτροπῆς ἁ](#) · [Against Aphobus for Guardianship, Part 1](#) · 60 passages
- [κατὰ Ἀφόβου β](#) · [Against Aphobus, Part 2](#) · 22 passages
- [κατὰ Ἀριστοκράτους](#) · [Against Aristocrates](#) · 204 passages
- [κατὰ Ἀριστογείτονος ἁ](#) · [Against Aristogeiton, Part 1](#) · 90 passages
- [κατὰ Ἀριστογείτονος β](#) · [Against Aristogeiton, Part 2](#) · 23 passages
- [κατὰ Κόνωνος αἰκείας](#) · [Against ConAssault](#) · 41 passages
- [κατὰ Διονυσόδωρου βλάβης](#) · [Against Dionysodorus-Damage](#) · 41 passages
- [κατὰ Εὐέργου καὶ Μνησιβούλου ψευδομαρτυριῶν](#) · [Against Evergus and Mnesibulus-False Testimony](#) · 74 passages
- [κατὰ Μειδίου περὶ τοῦ Κονδύλου](#) · [Against Meidias-The Club](#) · 200 passages
- [κατὰ Νεαίρας](#) · [Against Neaera](#) · 102 passages
- [κατὰ Ὀλυμπιόδωρου βλάβης](#) · [Against Olympiodorus-Damage](#) · 53 passages

- [κατὰ Φιλίππου α΄ · Against Philip I · 45 passages](#)
- [κατὰ Φιλίππου β΄ · Against Philip II · 27 passages](#)
- [κατὰ Φιλίππου γ΄ · Against Philip III · 60 passages](#)
- [κατὰ Φιλίππου δ΄ · Against Philip IV · 64 passages](#)
- [κατὰ Στεφάνου ψευδομαρτυριῶν α΄ · Against Stephanus-False Testimony A · 84 passages](#)
- [κατὰ Στεφάνου ψευδομαρτυριῶν β΄ · Against Stephanus-False Testimony B · 27 passages](#)
- [κατὰ Τιμοκράτους · Against Timocrates · 204 passages](#)
- [ἔφεσις πρὸς Εὐβουλίδην · Appeal To Eubulides · 66 passages](#)
- [παραγραφὴ ὑπὲρ Φορμίωνος · Counterplea for Phormion · 55 passages](#)
- [παραγραφὴ πρὸς Ναυσίμακον καὶ Ξενοπίθην · Counterplea To Nausimachus and Xenopithes · 26 passages](#)
- [παραγραφὴ πρὸς Πανταίνετον · Counterplea To Pantaenetos · 55 passages](#)
- [προοίμια δημηγορικὰ · Demagogic Prologues · 134 passages](#)
- [ἐπιτάφιος · Epitaph · 36 passages](#)
- [ἔρωτικὸς · Erotic · 49 passages](#)
- [Ὀλυνθιακὸς α΄ · First Olynthiac · 26 passages](#)
- [ὑπὲρ Μεγαλοπολιτῶν · For the Megalopolitans · 26 passages](#)
- [Ἀποσπάσματα τῶν Δημοσθενικῶν Λόγων · Fragments of Demosthenic Orations · 70 passages](#)
- [ὑπὲρ Κτησιφῶντος περὶ τοῦ στεφάνου · In Defense of Ctesiphthe Crown · 274 passages](#)
- [ὑπὲρ τῆς Ῥοδίων ἐλευθερίας · In Defense of the Rhodians' Freedom · 33 passages](#)
- [ἔνδειξις κατὰ Θεοκρίνου · Indictment-Theocrines · 57 passages](#)
- [ἐπιστολὴ · Letter of Philip · 20 passages](#)
- [Δημοσθένους ἐπιστολαὶ · Letters of Demosthenes · 87 passages](#)
- [Ὀλυνθιακὸς β΄ · Olynthiac 2 · 25 passages](#)
- [Ὀλυνθιακὸς γ΄ · Olynthiac 3 · 34 passages](#)
- [περὶ Ἀλοννήσου · On Alonnessus · 37 passages](#)
- [περὶ τῆς Ἀτελείας πρὸς Λεπτίνην · On Incompletion to Leptines · 156 passages](#)
- [περὶ τῆς εἰρήνης · On Peace · 21 passages](#)
- [περὶ συντάξεως · On Syntax · 32 passages](#)
- [περὶ τῶν ἐν Χερρονήσῳ · On the Affairs in Chersonese · 58 passages](#)
- [περὶ τοῦ Στεφάνου τῆς τριηραρκίας · On the Crown of the Trierarchy · 22 passages](#)
- [περὶ τῆς παραπροσβείας · On the Embassy · 300 passages](#)
- [περὶ τῶν συμμοριῶν · On the Symmories · 38 passages](#)
- [περὶ τῶν πρὸς Ἀλέξανδρον συνθηκῶν · On the Treaties with Alexander · 27 passages](#)
- [πρὸς Ἀπατούριον παραγραφὴ · To Apaturius for False Entry · 34 passages](#)
- [πρὸς Ἀφοβὸν ὑπὲρ Φάνου ψευδομαρτυριῶν γ΄ · To Aphobus-Behalf of Phanus for False Testimony, Part 3 · 51 passages](#)
- [πρὸς Βοιωτὸν περὶ προικὸς μητρώας · To Boeotian-Maternal Dowry · 50 passages](#)
- [πρὸς Βοιωτὸν περὶ τοῦ Ὀνόματος · To Boeotus-the Name · 40 passages](#)
- [πρὸς Καλλικλέα περὶ χωρίου βλάβης · To Callicles-Land Damage · 33 passages](#)
- [πρὸς Κάλλιππον · To Callippus · 28 passages](#)
- [πρὸς τὴν Λάκριτον παραγραφὴν · To Lacritus-Counterplea · 47 passages](#)
- [πρὸς Λεωκάρη περὶ τοῦ Ἀρχιάδου κλήρου · To Leocares-Archias' Estate · 64 passages](#)
- [πρὸς Μακάρτατον περὶ Ἀγνίου κλήρου · To Macartatus-Hagnius' Estate · 77 passages](#)

- [πρὸς Νικόστρατον περὶ ἀνδραπόδων ἀπογραφῆς · To Nicostratus-the Census of Slaves in Arethousa](#) · 29 passages
- [πρὸς Ὀνήτορα ἐξούλης α · To Onetor On Eviction A](#) · 36 passages
- [πρὸς Ὀνήτορα ἐξούλης β · To Onetor On Eviction B](#) · 16 passages
- [πρὸς Φαίνιππον περὶ ἀντιδόσεως · To Phainippus-Exchange](#) · 29 passages
- [πρὸς Φορμίωνα ὑπὲρ δανείου · To Phormio-Loan](#) · 44 passages
- [πρὸς Πολυκλέα περὶ τοῦ ἐπιτριηραρχήματος · To Polycles-the Trierarch's Duty](#) · 53 passages
- [πρὸς Σπουδίαν ὑπὲρ προικός · To Spoudias-Dowry](#) · 27 passages
- [πρὸς τὴν ἐπιστολὴν τὴν Φιλίππου · To the Letter of Philip](#) · 17 passages
- [πρὸς Τιμόθεον ὑπὲρ χρέως · To Timothy-Debt](#) · 52 passages
- [πρὸς Ζηνόθεμιν παραγραφὴ · To Zenothemis-Counterplea](#) · 30 passages